

Be the Judge — No. 2

Judge first. Then build one yourself.

Name: _____ Date: _____

You know this game. Every answer below is **correct** — you are judging the *explanations*.

1 = Just the answer — no reason.

2 = Gives a reason — but only tries one way.

3 = A real explanation — it works no matter what you try.

The same score can go to more than one answer.

Part 1 — You be the judge

Three friends pick 13 grapes. Can they share them equally — the same number each, none left over?

Answer A

“No. Three equal shares means the total is a number you say when counting by 3s. Counting by 3s goes 12, then 15 — it skips 13. So no way of sharing can ever come out equal.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer B

“No, they can’t.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer C

“No. I tried it: I gave each friend 4 grapes, one at a time, going around the circle. That used up 12 grapes, and there was 1 grape left over with nowhere fair to go. So sharing the 13 grapes equally doesn’t work.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Part 2 — Judge again

Four answers this time. Same scores: **1** = just the answer, **2** = a reason but only one try, **3** = a real explanation. Circle one for each.

Tomas says: “If you add 1 to a number, the answer is always bigger than the number you started with.” Is he right — for every number?

Answer A

“Yes. I checked: $5 + 1 = 6$, and 6 is bigger than 5. So he’s right.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer B

“Yes, Tomas is definitely right. I am completely sure about this — it always works, every single time, and anyone who has ever added numbers knows it. It’s just true.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer C

“Yes.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Answer D

“Yes. Adding 1 means counting up one more step. Whatever number you start on, you land one step above it — so the answer is always bigger, no matter which number you pick.”

Score it (circle one): **1** **2** **3**

Part 3 — Build one: finish the last line

A new game. Here is a question and an explanation that is almost finished — every line is **one complete sentence**. The last line is missing. Write it.

Can 5 kids split 16 marbles equally — the same number each, none left over?

The explanation — one sentence per line:

1. Equal shares for 5 kids means the total is a number you say when counting by 5s.
2. Counting by 5s goes 5, 10, 15, 20 — it skips 16.
- 3.

Part 4 — Build one: finish the last two lines

Same game — but now **two** lines are missing. One sentence each.

**A ribbon is 10 cm long. Maya wants to cut all of it into 3 cm pieces, with nothing left over.
Can she?**

The explanation — one sentence per line:

1. Every piece uses exactly 3 cm, so the pieces use up 3, 6, 9, 12 ... cm of ribbon.
- 2.

3.

Answer Key — for parents

What this sheet does. Two judging rounds on familiar ground, then the first small step from *recognizing* a good explanation to *producing* one: they finish a printed explanation — last line only, then last two lines.

The scores.

Part 1: A $\rightarrow$ 3 (counting by 3s skips 13 — rules out every share at once), B $\rightarrow$ 1 (no reason), C $\rightarrow$ 2 (tries one way of sharing).

Part 2: A $\rightarrow$ 2 (checks one number), B $\rightarrow$ 1 (lots of words, total confidence, zero reason), C $\rightarrow$ 1, D $\rightarrow$ 3 (counting up one step works for every number).

The Part 2 twist. This claim is *true* — the answer is yes. That makes “I checked $5 + 1 = 6$ ” extra tempting: the check works! But one number checked says nothing about every number. A “yes, always” needs a reason that covers all cases, exactly like a “no, never” does. If they hesitate over A, ask: does that show it works for a million too?

The build parts — what counts. Any sentence in their own words that lands the conclusion earns it.

Part 3, line 3: something like “So 16 marbles can never be split equally among 5 kids.”

Part 4, line 2: the key step — “That list skips 10: after 9 cm only 1 cm is left, too short for a piece.” **Line 3:** “So she can’t cut the whole ribbon into 3 cm pieces.”

One complete sentence per line, ending with a period — short is fine, run-ons are the thing to catch.

How to run it. Judging can be out loud as before. Parts 3–4 they should write themselves — that’s the point of the sheet — but it’s one sentence at a time, and saying it aloud first before writing it down is fair play.